COLLECTION OF CTL DECISIONS

Standard: IEC 61010-1:1990 +A1:1992+A2:1995	**Sub clause:** 1.2	**Sheet n. 295** **Page 1(1)**
Subject: Object	**Key words:** - Scope - Software Safety	**Decision taken by ETF3 and confirmed by CTL at its 38th meeting, in Toronto**

Question:

If safety is dependent on Software, what criteria do laboratories employ to ensure compliance?

Decision:

Software safety is not specifically addressed in IEC 61010-1 at present and therefore, there are no specific guidelines for this work. A draft collateral standard is in preparation and also IEC 61508 deals with this topic.

Generally, it is advised that devices should not be dependent on software alone for their safety. There should be a separate independent means provided which acts to prevent a dangerous condition arising.

Explanation:

Experience shows that the analysis of software systems to ensure their safe operation is very difficult and in practice, can only provide a measure of confidence. Additionally, the methods of performing the examination are not widely agreed upon and therefore, subject to doubt. In these circumstances, it is preferred to adopt safety limit methods known from experience to be effective.